Variable Name	Variable Type	Description	Notes
hospital_id	string	Unique hospital identification number, consistent over the full window (2000-2025).	See section 2.5 and appendix A section A.5 for further details.
hospital_cms_id	string	CMS Provider Number	Entries with "M..." denote hospitals combined with parent hospitals for reporting in CMS after the acquisition, the provider number following the "M" is the parent provider number.
deal_id	string	Unique deal identification number.	
deal_year	year	Year of deal.	Determined by hierarchy: 1. confirmed closing date, 2. confirmed announcement date, 3. deal source reported closing date, 4. deal source reported announcement date.
hospital_name	string	Name of hospital.	
hospital_city	string	City of hospital location.	As reported by CMS.
hospital_state	string	State of hospital location.	As reported by CMS.
hospital_address	string	Street address of hospital location.	As reported by CMS.
hospital_zip	numeric	5-digit postal ZIP code of hospital location.	As reported by CMS.

deal_system_level	numeric	Deal at system level indicator.	=1 if deal occurs at system level, =0 if deal at hospital level.
system_name	string	Name of system.	Available if deal at system level.
deal_type	string	Private Equity deal type.	PE deal types include LBO, Growth Equity, and PIPE
deal_announcement_date	date	Verified deal announcement date, if available.	Verified with external sources (press release, local news, national news, etc.).
deal_closing_date	date	Verified deal closing date, if available.	Verified with external sources (press release, local news, national news, etc.).
deal_announcement_link	link	Link to verification of deal announcement date.	
deal_closing_link	link	Link to verification of deal closing date.	
deal_exit_date	date	Date of PE exit from investment.	Tracked for LBO deal type only. See appendix A section A.6 for further details.
deal_exit_type	string	Type of PE exit from investment.	Tracked for LBO deal type only. See appendix A section A.6 for further details. Exit types include Ongoing, IPO, M&A, PE-to-PE, Closure, and Bankruptcy.

deal_exit_link	link	Link to verification of deal exit date.	
hca_flag	numeric	HCA PE deal indicator.	=1 if included in HCA PE deal, =0 if not.
opened_under_pe_flag	numeric	Hospital opened under PE control indicator.	= 1 if hospital opened under PE control, = 0 if not.
lbo_ambigious_flag	numeric	LBO status for hospital is ambiguous but typically accepted in the literature indicator.	= 1 if deal LBO status is ambiguous, = 0 if not.
stac_status_dispute_flag	numeric	STAC status dispute indicator.	= 1 when a hospital is short-term designated in POS but not short-term designated in other sources (AHA, Medicare procedural volume, HCRIS), = 0 when not